

you to flee from the coming wrath? ⁸Produce fruit, then, in keeping with repentance. ⁹And do not presume to say to yourselves, ‘We have Abraham as our father.’ For I tell you that out of these stones God can raise up children for Abraham. ¹⁰The axe lies ready at the root of the trees, and every tree that does not produce good fruit will be cut down and thrown into the fire.

¹¹I baptize you with water^a for repentance, but after me will come One more powerful than I, whose sandals I am not worthy to carry. He will baptize you with the Holy Spirit and with fire.^b ¹²His winnowing fork is in His hand to clear His threshing floor and to gather His wheat into the barn; but He will burn up the chaff with unquenchable fire.”

The Baptism of Jesus

Mark 1:9–11; Luke 3:21–22; John 1:29–34

¹³At that time Jesus came from Galilee to the Jordan to be baptized by John. ¹⁴But John tried to prevent Him, saying, “I need to be baptized by You, and do You come to me?”

¹⁵“Let it be so now,” Jesus replied. “It is fitting for us to fulfill all righteousness in this way.” Then John permitted Him.

¹⁶As soon as Jesus was baptized, He went up out of the water. Suddenly the heavens were opened,^c and He saw^d the Spirit of God descending like a dove and resting on Him. ¹⁷And a voice from heaven said, “This is My beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased!”

The Temptation of Jesus

Mark 1:12–13; Luke 4:1–13

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¹Then Jesus was led by the Spirit into the wilderness to be tempted by the devil.

²After fasting forty days and forty nights, He was hungry.

³The tempter came to Him and said, “If You are the Son of God, tell these stones to become bread.”

⁴But Jesus answered, “It is written:
‘Man shall not live on bread alone,

^a Or in water ^b Or in the Holy Spirit and in fire ^c NA, BYZ, and TR the heavens were opened to Him ^d Or and he saw; see John 1:32–33/JHN 1:32–33.

The First Disciples

Mark 1:16–20; Luke 5:1–11; John 1:35–42

¹⁸ As Jesus was walking beside the Sea of Galilee, He saw two brothers, Simon called Peter and his brother Andrew. They were casting a net into the sea, for they were fishermen. ¹⁹ “Come, follow Me,” Jesus said, “and I will make you fishers of men.” ²⁰ And at once they left their nets and followed Him.

²¹ Going on from there, He saw two other brothers, James son of Zebedee and his brother John. They were in a boat with their father Zebedee, mending their nets. Jesus called them, ²² and immediately they left the boat and their father and followed Him.

Jesus Heals the Multitudes

Mark 3:7–12; Luke 6:17–19

²³ Jesus went throughout Galilee, teaching in their synagogues, preaching the gospel of the kingdom, and healing every disease and sickness among the people. ²⁴ News about Him spread all over Syria, and people brought to Him all who were ill with various diseases, those suffering acute pain, the demon-possessed, those having seizures, and the paralyzed, and He healed them.

²⁵ Large crowds followed Him, having come from Galilee, the Decapolis,^a Jerusalem, Judea, and beyond the Jordan.

The Sermon on the Mount



¹ When Jesus saw the crowds, He went up on the mountain and sat down. His disciples came to Him,

² and He began to teach them, saying:

The Beatitudes

Psalm 1:1–6; Luke 6:20–23

³ “Blessed are the poor in spirit,

^a That is, the Ten Cities

³ Jesus replied, “Truly, truly, I tell you, no one can see the kingdom of God unless he is born again.”^a

⁴ “How can a man be born when he is old?” Nicodemus asked. “Can he enter his mother’s womb a second time to be born?”

⁵ Jesus answered, “Truly, truly, I tell you, no one can enter the kingdom of God unless he is born of water and the Spirit. ⁶ Flesh is born of flesh, but spirit is born of the Spirit. ⁷ Do not be amazed that I said, ‘You^b must be born again.’ ⁸ The wind blows where it wishes. You hear its sound, but you do not know where it comes from or where it is going. So it is with everyone born of the Spirit.”

⁹ “How can this be?” Nicodemus asked.

¹⁰ “You are Israel’s teacher,” said Jesus, “and you do not understand these things? ¹¹ Truly, truly, I tell you, we speak of what we know, and we testify to what we have seen, and yet you people do not accept our testimony.

¹² If I have told you about earthly things and you do not believe, how will you believe if I tell you about heavenly things? ¹³ No one has ascended into heaven except the One who descended from heaven— the Son of Man.^c ¹⁴ Just as Moses lifted up the snake in the wilderness, so the Son of Man must be lifted up, ¹⁵ that everyone who believes in Him may have eternal life.”^d

¹⁶ For God so loved the world that He gave His one and only^e Son, that everyone who believes in Him shall not perish but have eternal life. ¹⁷ For God did not send His Son into the world to condemn the world, but to save the world through Him. ¹⁸ Whoever believes in Him is not condemned, but whoever does not believe has already been condemned, because he has not believed in the name of God’s one and only Son.

¹⁹ And this is the verdict: The Light has come into the world, but men loved the darkness rather than the Light because their deeds were evil. ²⁰ Everyone who does evil hates the Light, and does not come into the Light for fear that his deeds will be exposed. ²¹ But whoever practices the truth comes into the Light, so that it may be seen clearly that what he has done has been accomplished in God.”^f

John’s Testimony about Jesus

²² After this, Jesus and His disciples went into the Judean countryside, where He spent some time with them and baptized.

^a Or *born from above*; also in verse 7. ^b The Greek word for *you* is plural; also in verse 12.

^c BYZ and TR include *who is in heaven*. ^d Or *everyone who believes may have eternal life in Him*. ^e Or *only begotten or unique*; also in verse 18 ^f Some translators close this quotation after verse 15.

Love One Another

Romans 12:9–13; 1 John 3:11–24

³¹ When Judas had gone out, Jesus said, “Now the Son of Man is glorified, and God is glorified in Him. ³² If God is glorified in Him,^d God will also glorify the Son in Himself — and will glorify Him at once.

³³ Little children, I am with you only a little while longer. You will look for Me, and as I said to the Jews, so now I say to you: ‘Where I am going, you cannot come.’

³⁴ A new commandment I give you: Love one another. As I have loved you, so you also must love one another. ³⁵ By this everyone will know that you are My disciples, if you love one another.”

Jesus Predicts Peter’s Denial

Matthew 26:31–35; Mark 14:27–31; Luke 22:31–38

³⁶ “Lord, where are You going?” Simon Peter asked.

Jesus answered, “Where I am going, you cannot follow Me now, but you will follow later.”

³⁷ “Lord,” said Peter, “why can’t I follow You now? I will lay down my life for You.”

³⁸ “Will you lay down your life for Me?” Jesus replied. “Truly, truly, I tell you, before the rooster crows, you will deny Me three times.”^f]

In My Father’s House Are Many Rooms



¹ “Do not let your hearts be troubled. You believe in God;^a believe in Me as well.

² In My Father’s house are many rooms. If it were not so, would I have told you that I am going there to prepare a place for you?^b ³ And if I go and prepare a place for you, I will come back and welcome you into My presence, so that you also may be where I am. ⁴ You know the way to the place where I am going.”^c

^a Or Believe in God ^b Or If it were not so, I would have told you. I am going there to prepare a place for you. ^c BYZ and TR And where I go you know, and the way you know.